

Naming Text Encodings to Demystify Them

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*If you can't name it, you probably don't know what it is
If you don't know what it is, you don't know what it isn't*
Tony Van Eerd

Target

C++23

Abstract

For historical reasons, all text encodings mentioned in the standard are derived from a locale object, which does not necessarily match the reality of how programs and systems interact.

This model works poorly with modern understanding of text, ie the Unicode model separates encoding from locales which are purely rules for formatting and text transformations but do not affect which characters are represented by a sequence of code units.

Moreover, the standard does not provide a way to query which encodings are expected or used by the system, leading to guesswork and unavoidable UB.

This paper introduces the notions of literal encoding, system encoding and a way to query them.

Examples

Listing the encoding

```
#include <text_encoding>
#include <iostream>

void print(const std::text_encoding & c) {
    std::cout << c.name()
    << " (iana mib: " << c.mib() << ")\n"
    << "Aliases:\n";
    for(auto && a : c.aliases()) {
```

```

        std::cout << '\t' << a << '\n';
    }
}

int main() {
    std::cout << "Literal Encoding: ";
    print(std::text_encoding::literal());
    std::cout << "Wide Literal Encoding: ";
    print(std::text_encoding::wide_literal());
    std::cout << "System Encoding: ";
    print(std::text_encoding::system());
    std::cout << "Wide system Encoding: ";
    print(std::text_encoding::wide_system());
}

```

Compiled with `g++ -fwide-exec-charset=EBCDIC-US -fexec-charset=SHIFT_JIS`, this program may display:

```

Literal Encoding: SHIFT_JIS (iana mib: 17)
Aliases:
    Shift_JIS
    MS_Kanji
    csShiftJIS

Wide Literal Encoding: EBCDIC-US (iana mib: 2078)
Aliases:
    EBCDIC-US
    csEBCDICUS

System Encoding: UTF-8 (iana mib: 106)
Aliases:
    UTF-8
    csUTF8

Wide system Encoding: ISO-10646-UCS-4 (IANA mib: 1001)
Aliases:
    ISO-10646-UCS-4
    csUCS4

```

LWG3314

[time.duration.io] specifies that the unit for microseconds is μ on systems able to display it. This is currently difficult to detect and implement properly.

The following allows an implementation to use μ if it is supported by both the execution encoding and the encoding attached to the stream.

```

template<class traits, class Rep, class Period>
void print_suffix(basic_ostream<char, traits>& os, const duration<Rep, Period>& d)
{
    if constexpr(text_encoding::literal() == text_encoding::utf8) {
        if (os.getloc().encoding() == text_encoding::utf8) {

```

```

        os << d.count() << "\u00B5s"; // μ
        return;
    }
}
os << d.count() << "us";
}

```

A more complex implementation may support more encodings, such as iso-8859-1.

Asserting a specific encoding is set

On POSIX, matching encodings is done by name, which pulls the entire database. To avoid that we propose a method to asserting that the system encoding is as expected. such method mixed to only pull in the strings associated with this encoding:

```

int main() {
    return text_encoding::system_is<text_encoding::id::UTF8>();
}

```

User construction

To support other use cases such as interoperability with other libraries or internet protocols, text_encoding can be constructed by users

```

text_encoding my_utf8("utf8");
assert(my_utf8.name() == "utf8"sv); // Get the user provided name back
assert(my_utf8.mib() == text_encoding::id::UTF8);

text_encoding my_utf8_2(text_encoding::id::UTF8);
assert(my_utf8_2.name() == "UTF-8"sv); // Get the preferred name for the implementation
assert(my_utf8_2.mib() == text_encoding::id::UTF8);
assert(my_utf8 == my_utf8_2);

```

Unregistered encoding

Unregistered encoding are also supported. They have the other mib, no aliases and are compared by names:

```

text_encoding wtf8("WTF-8");
assert(wtf8.name() == "WTF-8"sv);
assert(wtf8.mib() == text_encoding::id::other);

//encodings with the \tcode{other} mib are compared by name, ignoring case, hyphens and underscores
assert(wtf8 == text_encoding("___wtf8__"));

```

Revisions

Revision 4

- Change operator==(encoding, mib) for id::other
- Add wording for freestanding
- Improve wording
- Improve alias comparison algorithm to match unicode TR22

Revision 3

- Add a list of encodings NOT registered by IANA
- Add a comparative list of IANA/WHATWG
- Address names that do not uniquely identify encodings
- Add more examples

Revision 2

- Add all the enumerators of rcf 3008
- Add a mib constructor to text_encoding
- Add system_is and wide_system_is function templates

Revision 1

- Add more example and clarifications
- Require hosted implementations to support all the names registered in [[rfc3808](#)].

Use cases

This paper aims to make C++ simpler by exposing information that is currently hidden to the point of being perceived as magical by many. It also leaves no room for a language below C++ by ensuring that text encoding does not require the use of C functions.

The primary use cases are:

- Ensuring a specific string encoding at compile time
- Ensuring at runtime that string literals are compatible with the system encoding
- Custom conversion function
- locale-independent text transformation

Non goals

This facility aims to help **identify** text encodings and does not want to solve encoding conversion and decoding. Future text encoders and decoders may use the proposed facility as a way to identify their source and destination encoding. The current facility is *just* a fancy name.

The many text encodings of a C++ system

Text in a technical sense is a sequence of bytes to which is virtually attached an encoding. Without encoding, a blob of data simply cannot be interpreted as text.

In many cases, the encoding used to encode a string is not communicated along with that string and its encoding is therefore presumed with more or less success.

Generally, it is useful to know the encoding of a string when

- Transferring data as text between systems or processes (I/O)
- Textual transformation of data
- Interpretation of a piece of data

In the purview of the standard, text I/O text originates from

- The source code (literals)
- The iostream library as well as system functions
- Environment variables and command-line arguments intended to be interpreted as text.

Locales provide text transformation and conversion facilities and as such, in the current model have an encoding attached to them.

There are therefore 3 sets of encodings of primary interest:

- The encoding of narrow and wide characters and string literals
- The narrow and wide encodings used by a program when sending or receiving strings from its environment
- The encoding of narrow and wide characters attached to a `std::locale` object

[*Note*: Because they have different code units sizes, narrow and wide strings have different encodings. `char8_t`, `char16_t`, `char32_t` literals are assumed to be respectively UTF-8, UTF-16 and UTF-32 encoded. — *end note*]

[*Note*: A program may have to deal with more encoding - for example, on Windows, the encoding of the console attached to `cout` may be different from the system encoding.

Likewise depending on the platform, paths may or may not have an encoding attached to them, and that encoding may either be a property of the platform or the filesystem itself. — *end note*]

The standard only has the notion of execution character sets (which implies the existence of execution encodings), whose definitions are locale-specific. That implies that the standard assumes that string literals are encoded in a subset of the encoding of the locale encoding.

This has to hold notably because it is not generally possible to differentiate runtime strings from compile-time literals at runtime.

This model does, however, present 1 shortcomings:

First, in practice, C++ software are often no longer compiled in the same environment as the one on which they are run and the entity providing the program may not have control over the environment on which it is run.

Both POSIX and C++ derives the encoding from the locale. Which is an unfortunate artifact of an era when 255 characters or less ought to be enough for anyone. Sadly, the locale can change at runtime, which means the encoding which is used by ctype and conversion functions can change at runtime. However, this encoding ought to be an immutable property as it is dictated by the environment (often the parent process). In the general case, it is not for a program to change the encoding expected by its environment. A C++ program sets the locale to "C" (see [\[N2346\]](#), 7.11.1.1.4) (which assumes a US ASCII encoding) during initialization, further losing information.

Many text transformations can be done in a locale-agnostic manner yet require the encoding to be known - as no text transformation can ever be applied without prior knowledge of what the encoding of that text is.

More importantly, it is difficult or impossible for a developer to diagnose an incompatibility between the locale-derived, encoding, the system-assumed encoding and the encoding of string literals.

Exposing the different encodings would let developers verify that that the system environment is compatible with the implementation-defined encoding of string literals, aka that the encoding and character set used to encode string literals are a strict subset of the encoding of the environment.

Identifying Encodings

To be able to expose the encoding to developers we need to be able to synthesize that information. The challenge, of course, is that there exist many encodings (hundreds), and many names to refer to each one. Fortunately there exist a database of registered encoding covering almost all encodings supported by operating systems and compilers. This database is maintained by IANA through a process described by [\[rfc2978\]](#).

This database lists over 250 registered character sets and for each:

- A name
- A unique identifier
- A set of known aliases

We propose to use that information to reliably identify encoding across implementations and systems.

Design Considerations

Encodings are orthogonal to locales

The following proposal is mostly independent of locales so that the relevant part can be implemented in an environment in which `<locale>` is not available, as well as to make sure we can transition `std::locale` to be more compatible with Unicode.

Naming

SG-16 is looking at rewording the terminology associated with text and encoding throughout the standard, this paper does not yet reflect that effort.

However “system encoding” and “literal encoding” are descriptive terms. In particular “system” is illustrative of the fact that a C++ program has, in the general case, no control over the encoding it is expected to produce and consume.

MIBEnum

We provide a `text_encoding::id` enum with the MIBEnum value of a few often used encodings for convenience. Because there is a rather large number of encodings and because this list may evolve faster than the standard, it was pointed out during early review that it would be detrimental to attempt to provide a complete list. [*Note: MIB stands for Management Information Base, which is IANA nomenclature, the name has no particular interest besides a desire not to deviate from the existing standards and practices. — end note*]

The enumerators `unknown` and `other` and their value are provided by the very same RFC such as:

- `other` designs an encoding not registered in the IANA Database, such that 2 encodings with the other `mib` are identical if their names compare equal.
- `unknown` is used when the encoding could not be determined. Under the current proposal, only default constructing a `text_encoding` object can produce that value. The encoding associated with the locale or environment is always known.

While MIBEnum was necessary to make that proposal implementable consistently across platforms, its main purpose is to remediate to the fact that encoding can have multiple inconsistent names across implementations.

However,

Name and aliases

The proposed API offers both a name and aliases. The `name` method reflects the name with which the `text_encoding` object was created, when applicable. This is notably important when the encoding is not registered, or its name differs from the IANA name.

Unique identification of encodings

The IANA database intends that the name refers to a specific set of characters. However, for historical reasons, there exist some names (like Shift-JIS) which describes several slightly different encoding. The intent of this proposal is that the names refer to the character sets as described by IANA. Further differentiation can be made in the application through out-of-band information such as the provenance of the text to which the encoding is associated. RFC2978 mandates that all names and aliases are unique.

Implementation flexibility

This proposal aims to be implementable on all platforms as such, it supports encoding not registered with IANA, does not impose that a freestanding implementation is aware of all registered encodings, and it let implementers provide their own aliases for IANA-registered encoding. Because the process for registering encodings is documented [rfc2978] implementations can (but are not required to) provide registered encodings not defined in [rfc3808] - in the case that RFC is updated out of sync of the standard. However, [rfc3808] is from 2004 and has not been updated. As the world converges to utf-8, new encodings are less likely to be registered.

Implementations may not extend the `text_encoding::id` as to guarantee source compatibility.

const char*

A primary use case is to enable people to write their own conversion functions. Unfortunately, most APIs expect NULL-terminated strings, which is why we return a `const char*`.

Freestanding

In order for this class to be compatible with free standing environments, care has been taken to avoid allocation and exceptions. As such, we put an upper bound on the name of encoding pass to `text_encoding` constructor of 63+1 characters. Per rfc2978, the primary name must not exceed 40 characters.

Name comparison

Names and aliases are compared ignoring case and non alpha numeric characters, in a way that follows [Unicode recommendations](#)

Implementation

The following proposal has been prototyped using a modified version of GCC to expose the encoding information.

On Windows, the run-time encoding can be determined by GetACP - and then map to MIB values, while on POSIX platform it corresponds to value of nl_langinfo when the environment ("") locale is set - before the program's locale is set to C.

On OSX CFStringGetSystemEncoding and CFStringConvertEncodingToIANACharSetName can also be used.

While exposing the literal encoding is novel, a few libraries do expose the system encoding, including Qt and wxWidget, and use the IANA registry.

Part of this proposal is available on [Compiler explorer](#) (literal and wide_literal are not supported)

Compatibility with 3rd party systems

Qt

```
// Get a QTextCodec able to convert the system encoding to QString
auto codec = QTextCodec::codecForMib(std::text_encoding::system().mib());
```

ICU

```
// Get a UConverter object able to convert to and from the system encoding to
//ICU's internal encoding.
UErrorCode err;
UConverter* converter = ucnv_open(std::text_encoding::system().name(), &err);

// Check whether a UConverter converts to the system encoding
bool compatibleWithSystemEncoding(UConverter* converter)
{
    UErrorCode err;
    const char* name == ucnv_getName(converter, &err);
    assert(U_SUCCESS(err));
    return std::text_encoding(name) == std::text_encoding::system();
}
```

ICONV

```
// Convert from utf-8 to the system encoding, transliterating if necessary
iconv_t converter
    = iconv_open(std::format("{}//TRANSLIT", std::text_encoding::literal()).c_str(), "utf-8");
```

FAQ

Why rely on the IANA registry ?

The IANA registry has been picked for several reasons

- It can be referenced through an RFC in the standard
- It has wide vendor buy-in
- It is used as a primary source for many tools including ICU and iconv, and many programming languages and libraries.
- It has an extensive number of entries which makes it uniquely suitable for the wide portability requirements of C++. Notably, it supports IBM codepages.
- It provides stable enum values designed for efficient and portable comparison in programming languages
- There is a well-specified support for unregistered encoding
- There is a well-specified process to register new encodings

We also considered the WHATWG Encoding specification. But this specification is designed specifically for the web and has no provision for EBCDIC encodings, provide no numerical values, etc.

Annex A provides a comparative list of IANA and WHATWG lists.

Extensive research didn't find any other registry worth considering. It would be possible to maintain our own list in the standard, but this would put an undue burden on the committee and risks reducing portability with existing tools, libraries and other languages.

Why not return a `text_encoding::id` rather than a `text_encoding` object?

Some implementations may need to return a non-registered encoding, in which case they would return `mib::other` and a custom name.

`text_encoding::system()` and `text_encoding::system_mib()` (not proposed) would generate the same code in an optimized build.

But handling names is expensive?

To ensure that the proposal is implementable in a constrained environment, `text_encoding` has a limit of 63 characters per encoding name which is sufficient to support all encodings we are aware of (registered or not)

It seems like names and mib are separate concerns?

Not all encodings are registered (even if most are), it is therefore not possible to identify all encoding uniquely by mib. Encodings may have many names, but some platforms will have a

preferred name.

The combination of a name + a mib covers 100% of use cases. Aliases further help with integration with third-party libraries or to develop tools that need mime encoding names.

Why can't there be vendor provided MIBs?

This would be meaningless in portable code. mib is only useful as a mechanism to identify **portably** encoding and to increase compatibility across third-party libraries.

It does not prevent the support of unregistered encodings:

```
text_encoding wtf8("WTF-8");
assert(wtf8.name() == "WTF-8"sv);
assert(wtf8.mib() == text_encoding::id::other);
```

Why can't there be a text_encoding(name, mib) constructor?

Same reason, if users are allowed to construct text_encoding from registered names or names otherwise unknown from the implementation with an arbitrary mib, it becomes impossible to maintain the invariant of the class (the relation between mib and name), which would make the interface much harder to use, without providing any functionality.

I just want to check that my platform is utf-8 without paying for all these other encodings?

we added system_is to that end.

```
int main() {
    assert(text_encoding::system_is<text_encoding::id::UTF8>
           && "Non UTF8 encoding detected, go away");
}
```

This can be implemented in a way that only stores in the program the necessary information for that particular encoding (unless aliases is called at runtime).

On Windows and OSX, only calling encoding::aliases would pull any data in the program, even if calling system.

What is the cost of calling aliases?

My crude implementation pulls in 30Ki of data when calling aliases or the name constructor, or system() (on POSIX).

Future work

Exposing the notion of text encoding in the core and library language gives us the tools to solve some problems in the standard.

Notably, it offers a sensible way to do locale-independent, encoding-aware padding in `std::format` as in described in [\[P1868\]](#).

While this gives us the tools to handle encoding, it does not fix the core wording.

Proposed wording

Add the header `<text_encoding>` to the "C++ library headers" table in [headers], in a place that respects the table's current alphabetic order.

Add the header `<text_encoding>` to table [headers.cpp.fs] (freestanding).

Add the macro `__cpp_lib_text_encoding` to [version.syn], in a place that respects the current alphabetic order:

```
#define __cpp_lib_text_encoding 201911L (**placeholder**) // also in text_encoding
```

Add a new header `<text_encoding>`.

A `text_encoding` describes a text encoding portably across platforms by exposing data from the Character Sets database described by [rfc2978] and [rfc3808].

```
namespace std {

struct text_encoding{

    inline constexpr size_t max_name_lenght = 63;

    enum class id : int_least32_t {
        other = 1,
        unknown = 2,
        ASCII = 3,
        ISOLatin1 = 4,
        ISOLatin2 = 5,
        ISOLatin3 = 6,
        ISOLatin4 = 7,
        ISOLatinCyrillic = 8,
        ISOLatinArabic = 9,
        ISOLatinGreek = 10,
        ISOLatinHebrew = 11,
        ISOLatin5 = 12,
        ISOLatin6 = 13,
        ISOTextComm = 14,
        HalfWidthKatakana = 15,
        JISEncoding = 16,
        ShiftJIS = 17,
        EUCPkFmtJapanese = 18,
        EUCLixWidJapanese = 19,
        ISO4UnitedKingdom = 20,
        ISO11SwedishForNames = 21,
        ISO15Italian = 22,
        ISO17Spanish = 23,
        ISO21German = 24,
        ISO60DanishNorwegian = 25,
        ISO69French = 26,
        ISO10646UTF1 = 27,
        ISO646basic1983 = 28,
```

INVARIANT = 29,
ISO2IntlRefVersion = 30,
NATSSEFI = 31,
NATSSEFIADD = 32,
NATSDANO = 33,
NATSDANOADD = 34,
ISO10Swedish = 35,
KSC56011987 = 36,
ISO2022KR = 37,
EUCKR = 38,
ISO2022JP = 39,
ISO2022JP2 = 40,
ISO13JISC6220jp = 41,
ISO14JISC6220ro = 42,
ISO16Portuguese = 43,
ISO18Greek70ld = 44,
ISO19LatinGreek = 45,
ISO25French = 46,
ISO27LatinGreek1 = 47,
ISO5427Cyrillic = 48,
ISO42JISC62261978 = 49,
ISO47BSViewdata = 50,
ISO49INIS = 51,
ISO50INIS8 = 52,
ISO51INISCyrillic = 53,
ISO54271981 = 54,
ISO5428Greek = 55,
ISO57GB1988 = 56,
ISO58GB231280 = 57,
ISO61Norwegian2 = 58,
ISO70VideotexSuppl = 59,
ISO84Portuguese2 = 60,
ISO85Spanish2 = 61,
ISO86Hungarian = 62,
ISO87JISX0208 = 63,
ISO88Greek7 = 64,
ISO89ASMO449 = 65,
ISO90 = 66,
ISO91JISC62291984a = 67,
ISO92JISC62991984b = 68,
ISO93JIS62291984badd = 69,
ISO94JIS62291984hand = 70,
ISO95JIS62291984handadd = 71,
ISO96JISC62291984kana = 72,
ISO2033 = 73,
ISO99NAPLPS = 74,
ISO102T617bit = 75,
ISO103T618bit = 76,
ISO111ECMACyrillic = 77,
ISO121Canadian1 = 78,
ISO122Canadian2 = 79,

ISO123CSAZ24341985gr = 80,
ISO88596E = 81,
ISO88596I = 82,
ISO128T101G2 = 83,
ISO88598E = 84,
ISO88598I = 85,
ISO139CSN369103 = 86,
ISO141JUSIB1002 = 87,
ISO143IECP271 = 88,
ISO146Serbian = 89,
ISO147Macedonian = 90,
ISO150 = 91,
ISO151Cuba = 92,
ISO6937Add = 93,
ISO153GOST1976874 = 94,
ISO8859Supp = 95,
ISO10367Box = 96,
ISO158Lap = 97,
ISO159JISX02121990 = 98,
ISO646Danish = 99,
USDK = 100,
DKUS = 101,
KSC5636 = 102,
Unicode11UTF7 = 103,
ISO2022CN = 104,
ISO2022CNEXT = 105,
UTF8 = 106,
ISO885913 = 109,
ISO885914 = 110,
ISO885915 = 111,
ISO885916 = 112,
GBK = 113,
GB18030 = 114,
OSDEBCDICDF0415 = 115,
OSDEBCDICDF03IRV = 116,
OSDEBCDICDF041 = 117,
ISO115481 = 118,
KZ1048 = 119,
UCS2 = 1000,
UCS4 = 1001,
UnicodeASCII = 1002,
UnicodeLatin1 = 1003,
UnicodeJapanese = 1004,
UnicodeIBM1261 = 1005,
UnicodeIBM1268 = 1006,
UnicodeIBM1276 = 1007,
UnicodeIBM1264 = 1008,
UnicodeIBM1265 = 1009,
Unicode11 = 1010,
SCSU = 1011,
UTF7 = 1012,

UTF16BE = 1013,
UTF16LE = 1014,
UTF16 = 1015,
CESU8 = 1016,
UTF32 = 1017,
UTF32BE = 1018,
UTF32LE = 1019,
BOCU1 = 1020,
Windows30Latin1 = 2000,
Windows31Latin1 = 2001,
Windows31Latin2 = 2002,
Windows31Latin5 = 2003,
HPRoman8 = 2004,
AdobeStandardEncoding = 2005,
VenturaUS = 2006,
VenturaInternational = 2007,
DECMCS = 2008,
PC850Multilingual = 2009,
PC8DanishNorwegian = 2012,
PC862LatinHebrew = 2013,
PC8Turkish = 2014,
IBMSymbols = 2015,
IBMThai = 2016,
HPLegal = 2017,
HPPiFont = 2018,
HPMath8 = 2019,
HPPSMath = 2020,
HPDesktop = 2021,
VenturaMath = 2022,
MicrosoftPublishing = 2023,
Windows31J = 2024,
GB2312 = 2025,
Big5 = 2026,
Macintosh = 2027,
IBM037 = 2028,
IBM038 = 2029,
IBM273 = 2030,
IBM274 = 2031,
IBM275 = 2032,
IBM277 = 2033,
IBM278 = 2034,
IBM280 = 2035,
IBM281 = 2036,
IBM284 = 2037,
IBM285 = 2038,
IBM290 = 2039,
IBM297 = 2040,
IBM420 = 2041,
IBM423 = 2042,
IBM424 = 2043,
PC8CodePage437 = 2011,

IBM500 = 2044,
IBM851 = 2045,
PCp852 = 2010,
IBM855 = 2046,
IBM857 = 2047,
IBM860 = 2048,
IBM861 = 2049,
IBM863 = 2050,
IBM864 = 2051,
IBM865 = 2052,
IBM868 = 2053,
IBM869 = 2054,
IBM870 = 2055,
IBM871 = 2056,
IBM880 = 2057,
IBM891 = 2058,
IBM903 = 2059,
IBBM904 = 2060,
IBM905 = 2061,
IBM918 = 2062,
IBM1026 = 2063,
IBMEBCDICATDE = 2064,
EBCDICATDEA = 2065,
EBCDICCAFR = 2066,
EBCDICDKNO = 2067,
EBCDICDKNOA = 2068,
EBCDICFISE = 2069,
EBCDICFISEA = 2070,
EBCDICFR = 2071,
EBCDICIT = 2072,
EBCDICPT = 2073,
EBCDICES = 2074,
EBCDICESA = 2075,
EBCDICESSE = 2076,
EBCDICUK = 2077,
EBCDICUS = 2078,
Unknown8BiT = 2079,
Mnemonic = 2080,
Mnem = 2081,
VISCII = 2082,
VIQR = 2083,
KOI8R = 2084,
HZGB2312 = 2085,
IBM866 = 2086,
PC775Baltic = 2087,
KOI8U = 2088,
IBM00858 = 2089,
IBM00924 = 2090,
IBM01140 = 2091,
IBM01141 = 2092,
IBM01142 = 2093,

```

    IBM01143 = 2094,
    IBM01144 = 2095,
    IBM01145 = 2096,
    IBM01146 = 2097,
    IBM01147 = 2098,
    IBM01148 = 2099,
    IBM01149 = 2100,
    Big5HKSCS = 2101,
    IBM1047 = 2102,
    PTCP154 = 2103,
    Amiga1251 = 2104,
    KOI7switched = 2105,
    BRF = 2106,
    TSCII = 2107,
    CP51932 = 2108,
    windows874 = 2109,
    windows1250 = 2250,
    windows1251 = 2251,
    windows1252 = 2252,
    windows1253 = 2253,
    windows1254 = 2254,
    windows1255 = 2255,
    windows1256 = 2256,
    windows1257 = 2257,
    windows1258 = 2258,
    TIS620 = 2259,
    CP50220 = 2260,
    reserved = 3000
};

constexpr explicit text_encoding(string_view name);
constexpr text_encoding(text_encoding::id mib) noexcept;

constexpr id mib() const noexcept;
constexpr const char* name() const noexcept;

constexpr auto aliases() const noexcept -> see below;

constexpr bool operator==(const text_encoding & other) const noexcept;
constexpr bool operator==(text_encoding::id mib) const noexcept;

static consteval text_encoding literal();
static consteval text_encoding wide_literal();

static text_encoding system();
static text_encoding wide_system();

template<text_encoding::id id_>
static bool text_encoding::system_is();

```

```

template<text_encoding::id id_>
static bool text_encoding::wide_system_is();

private:
    id mib_; // exposition only
    char name_[max_name_lenght+1]; // exposition only
};

// hash support
template<class T> struct hash;
template<> struct hash<text_encoding>;

}

```

A *registered-character-set* is a character set registered by the process described in [rfc2978] and which is known of the implementation.

Let `bool COMP_NAME(const char* a, const char* b)` be a function that returns true if two strings encoded in the basic execution character set are identical, ignoring in each string, case and all characters outside of the ranges [a-z], [A-Z], [0-9], as well as 0 not preceded by a digit.

[Note: The enumerators of the `text_encoding::id` and their value match those specified in [rfc3808] with the "cs" prefixed removed. `text_encoding::id::UCS2` corresponds to `csUnicode` in [rfc3808] — end note]

```
constexpr explicit text_encoding(string_view name);
```

Preconditions: `name.size() < 64` is true.

Effects: If there exists an implementation-defined alias `a` of *registered-character-set* such that `COMP_NAME(a, name.c_str())` is true, initialize `mib_` with the `MIBenum` associated with that *registered-character-set*. Otherwise, initialize `mib_` with `text_encoding::id::other`.

Implementations shall return a valid `text_encoding` object for every `name` that matches either an alias or a name of a *registered-character-set* listed in [rfc3808].

[Note: Freestanding implementations are not required to provide this method — end note]

Postconditions: `string_view(name_) == name`.

```
constexpr text_encoding(text_encoding::id mib) noexcept;
```

Preconditions: `mib` has the value of one of the enumerators of `text_encoding::id`.

Postconditions: `mib_ == mib`.

```
constexpr id mib() const noexcept;
```

Returns: `mib_`.

[Note: The enumerator value `text_encoding::id::unknown` is provided for compatibility

with [rfc3808], text_encoding::mib() never returns text_encoding::id::unknown. — *end note*

```
constexpr const char* name() const noexcept;
```

Returns:

- name_ if strlen(name_) > 0 is true,
- Otherwise, if id != id::unknown is true, an implementation defined null-terminated string corresponding to the preferred name of the encoding on that platform.
- Otherwise, nullptr

```
constexpr auto aliases() const noexcept;
```

Returns: an implementation-defined object r representing a sequence of aliases such that:

- ranges::view<decltype(r)> is true,
- ranges::random_access_range<decltype(r)> is true,
- same_as<ranges::range_value_t<decltype(r)>, string_view> is true,
- !ranges::empty(r) || mib() == id::other is true.

If mib() is equal to the MIBEnum value of one of the *registered-character-sets*, r[0] is the name of the *registered-character-set*.

r contains the aliases of the *registered-character-set* as specified by [rfc2978].

r may contain implementation-defined values.

r does not contain duplicated values - the equality of 2 values is determined by COMP_NAME.

[*Note:* The order of elements in r is unspecified. — *end note*]

```
constexpr bool operator==(const text_encoding & other) const noexcept;
```

Returns: COMP_NAME(name(), other.name()) if mib() == id::other && other.mib() == id::other is true, otherwise mib() == other.mib().

```
constexpr bool operator==(text_encoding::id i) const noexcept;
```

Returns: mib() == i

```
static constexpr text_encoding literal();
```

Returns: a text_encoding object representing the narrow execution encoding.

```
static constexpr text_encoding wide_literal();
```

Returns: a text_encoding object representing the wide execution encoding.

```
static text_encoding system();
```

Return the presumed system narrow encoding. On a POSIX system, this is encoding that would be returned by `l_langinfo_l(CODESET, newlocale(LC_CTYPE, "", (locale_t)0)` at the start of the program.

This function always returns the same value during the lifetime of a program and is not affected by calls to `setlocale`.

```
static text_encoding wide_system();
```

Return the presumed system-wide encoding. On POSIX systems this is the encoding attached to the environment locale ("") at the start of the program.

[*Note:* This function shall always return the same value during the lifetime of a program and is not affected by calls to `setlocale`. — *end note*]

```
template<text_encoding::id id_>
static bool text_encoding::system_is();
```

Returns: Equivalent to `system() == id_`

```
template<text_encoding::id id_>
static bool text_encoding::system_wide_is();
```

Returns: Equivalent to `wide_system() == id_`

In `[locale]`:

```
namespace std {
    class locale {
    public:
        [...]

        // locale operations
        string name() const;

        text_encoding encoding() const;
        text_encoding wide_encoding() const;

    };
}
```

In `[locale.members]`:

```
string name() const;
```

Returns: The name of `*this`, if it has one; otherwise, the string `"*"`.

```
text_encoding encoding() const;
```

Returns: The text encoding for narrow strings associated with the locale `*this`.

```
text_encoding wide_encoding() const;
```

Returns: The text encoding for wide strings associated with the locale `*this`.

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Annex: Registered encodings

IANA	WHATWG
ANSI_X3.110-1983	
ASMO_449	
Adobe-Standard-Encoding	
Adobe-Symbol-Encoding	
Amiga-1251	
BOCU-1	
BRF	
BS_4730	
BS_viewdata	
Big5	Big5
Big5-HKSCS	
CESU-8	
CP50220	
CP51932	
CSA_Z243.4-1985-1	
CSA_Z243.4-1985-2	
CSA_Z243.4-1985-gr	
CSN_369103	
DEC-MCS	
DIN_66003	
DS_2089	
EBCDIC-AT-DE	
EBCDIC-AT-DE-A	
EBCDIC-CA-FR	
EBCDIC-DK-NO	
EBCDIC-DK-NO-A	
EBCDIC-ES	
EBCDIC-ES-A	
EBCDIC-ES-S	
EBCDIC-FI-SE	
EBCDIC-FI-SE-A	
EBCDIC-FR	
EBCDIC-IT	
EBCDIC-PT	
EBCDIC-UK	

EBCDIC-US	
ECMA-cyrillic	
ES	
ES2	
EUC-JP	EUC-JP
EUC-KR	EUC-KR
Extended_UNIX_Code_Fixed_Width_- for_Japanese	
GB18030	gb18030
GB2312	
GBK	GBK
GB_1988-80	
GB_2312-80	
GOST_19768-74	
HP-DeskTop	
HP-Legal	
HP-Math8	
HP-Pi-font	
HZ-GB-2312	
IBM-Symbols	
IBM-Thai	
IBM00858	
IBM00924	
IBM01140	
IBM01141	
IBM01142	
IBM01143	
IBM01144	
IBM01145	
IBM01146	
IBM01147	
IBM01148	
IBM01149	
IBM037	
IBM038	
IBM1026	
IBM1047	
IBM273	
IBM274	
IBM275	
IBM277	
IBM278	
IBM280	

IBM281	
IBM284	
IBM285	
IBM290	
IBM297	
IBM420	
IBM423	
IBM424	
IBM437	
IBM500	
IBM775	
IBM850	
IBM851	
IBM852	
IBM855	
IBM857	
IBM860	
IBM861	
IBM862	
IBM863	
IBM864	
IBM865	
IBM866	IBM866
IBM868	
IBM869	
IBM870	
IBM871	
IBM880	
IBM891	
IBM903	
IBM904	
IBM905	
IBM918	
IEC_P27-1	
INIS	
INIS-8	
INIS-cyrillic	
INVARIANT	
ISO-10646-J-1	
ISO-10646-UCS-2	
ISO-10646-UCS-4	
ISO-10646-UCS-Basic	
ISO-10646-UTF-1	

ISO-10646-Unicode-Latin1	
ISO-11548-1	
ISO-2022-CN	
ISO-2022-CN-EXT	
ISO-2022-JP	ISO-2022-JP
ISO-2022-JP-2	
ISO-2022-KR	
ISO-8859-1	
ISO-8859-1-Windows-3.0-Latin-1	
ISO-8859-1-Windows-3.1-Latin-1	
ISO-8859-10	ISO-8859-10
ISO-8859-13	ISO-8859-13
ISO-8859-14	ISO-8859-14
ISO-8859-15	ISO-8859-15
ISO-8859-16	ISO-8859-16
ISO-8859-2	ISO-8859-2
ISO-8859-2-Windows-Latin-2	
ISO-8859-3	ISO-8859-3
ISO-8859-4	ISO-8859-4
ISO-8859-5	ISO-8859-5
ISO-8859-6	ISO-8859-6
ISO-8859-6-E	
ISO-8859-6-I	
ISO-8859-7	ISO-8859-7
ISO-8859-8	ISO-8859-8
ISO-8859-8-E	
ISO-8859-8-I	ISO-8859-8-I
ISO-8859-9	
ISO-8859-9-Windows-Latin-5	
ISO-Unicode-IBM-1261	
ISO-Unicode-IBM-1264	
ISO-Unicode-IBM-1265	
ISO-Unicode-IBM-1268	
ISO-Unicode-IBM-1276	
ISO_10367-box	
ISO_2033-1983	
ISO_5427	
ISO_5427:1981	
ISO_5428:1980	
ISO_646.basic:1983	
ISO_646.irv:1983	
ISO_6937-2-25	
ISO_6937-2-add	

ISO_8859-supp	
IT	
JIS_C6220-1969-jp	
JIS_C6220-1969-ro	
JIS_C6226-1978	
JIS_C6226-1983	
JIS_C6229-1984-a	
JIS_C6229-1984-b	
JIS_C6229-1984-b-add	
JIS_C6229-1984-hand	
JIS_C6229-1984-hand-add	
JIS_C6229-1984-kana	
JIS_Encoding	
JIS_X0201	
JIS_X0212-1990	
JUS_I.B1.002	
JUS_I.B1.003-mac	
JUS_I.B1.003-serb	
KOI7-switched	
KOI8-R	KOI8-R
KOI8-U	KOI8-U
KSC5636	
KS_C_5601-1987	
KZ-1048	
Latin-greek-1	
MNEM	
MNEMONIC	
MSZ_7795.3	
Microsoft-Publishing	
NATS-DANO	
NATS-DANO-ADD	
NATS-SEFI	
NATS-SEFI-ADD	
NC_NC00-10:81	
NF_Z_62-010	
NF_Z_62-010_(1973)	
NS_4551-1	
NS_4551-2	
OSD_EBCDIC_DF03_IRV	
OSD_EBCDIC_DF04_1	
OSD_EBCDIC_DF04_15	
PC8-Danish-Norwegian	
PC8-Turkish	

PT	
PT2	
PTCP154	
SCSU	
SEN_850200_B	
SEN_850200_C	
Shift_JIS	Shift_JIS
T.101-G2	
T.61-7bit	
T.61-8bit	
TIS-620	
TSCII	
UNICODE-1-1	
UNICODE-1-1-UTF-7	
UNKNOWN-8BIT	
US-ASCII	
UTF-16	
UTF-16BE	UTF-16BE
UTF-16LE	UTF-16LE
UTF-32	
UTF-32BE	
UTF-32LE	
UTF-7	
UTF-8	UTF-8
VIQR	
VISCII	
Ventura-International	
Ventura-Math	
Ventura-US	
Windows-31J	
dk-us	
greek-ccitt	
greek7	
greek7-old	
hp-roman8	
iso-ir-90	
latin-greek	
latin-lap	
macintosh	macintosh
us-dk	
videotex-suppl	
windows-1250	windows-1250
windows-1251	windows-1251

windows-1252	windows-1252
windows-1253	windows-1253
windows-1254	windows-1254
windows-1255	windows-1255
windows-1256	windows-1256
windows-1257	windows-1257
windows-1258	windows-1258
windows-874	windows-874

Annex B: Known encodings not present in IANA

Lists of encoding known to some platforms but not registered to IANA. These might be incomplete as generating them proved challenging. These might still be supported through the other mib, but are not suitable for interexchange.

Windows

- 710 Arabic - Transparent Arabic
- 72 DOS-720 Arabic (Transparent ASMO); Arabic (DOS)
- 737 ibm737 OEM Greek (formerly 437G); Greek (DOS)
- 875 cp875 IBM EBCDIC Greek Modern
- 1361 Johab Korean (Johab)
- 57002 x-iscii-de ISCII Devanagari
- 57003 x-iscii-be ISCII Bangla
- 57004 x-iscii-ta ISCII Tamil
- 57005 x-iscii-te ISCII Telugu
- 57006 x-iscii-as ISCII Assamese
- 57007 x-iscii-or ISCII Odia
- 57008 x-iscii-ka ISCII Kannada
- 57009 x-iscii-ma ISCII Malayalam
- 57010 x-iscii-gu ISCII Gujarati
- 57011 x-iscii-pa ISCII Punjabi

Iconv

- CP1131

- CP1133
- GEORGIAN-ACADEMY
- GEORGIAN-PS
- CN-GB-ISOIR165
- Johab
- MacArabic
- MacCentralEurope
- MacCroatian
- MacCyrillic
- MacGreek
- MacHebrew
- MacIceland
- MacRoman
- MacRomania
- MacThai
- MacTurkish
- MacUkraine

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